

News Weekly

India has contained a Nipah virus outbreak, prompting several Asian countries to increase health screenings.

Indian authorities have successfully contained a Nipah virus outbreak, with two confirmed cases in West Bengal. The Health Ministry has reported that all 196 identified contacts have been quarantined and tested negative for the virus. Nipah is a zoonotic virus transmitted by fruit bats and pigs, characterized by a high fatality rate ranging from 40% to 75%, and currently lacks an effective vaccine. Although no cases have been reported outside of India, several Asian countries have heightened health screenings for travelers from India as a precautionary measure. This comes in response to earlier media reports regarding a surge in cases, which have since been described as "speculative and incorrect" (NBC News).



Researchers Launch Follow-Up Study on "Dark Oxygen"

Researchers are embarking on a follow-up study with a budget of **\$5.2 million** to delve deeper into the fascinating phenomenon known as "dark oxygen." This discovery was made at a depth of **4,000 meters** in the Clarion-Clipperton Zone of the Pacific Ocean. Since this area is too deep for photosynthesis, highly specialized landers will be utilized to investigate whether water molecules are splitting to generate the gas, even in the absence of light. This exciting expedition, generously supported by the **Nippon Foundation** and led by marine biologist **Andrew Sweetman**, will incorporate advanced pH-sensing instruments to confirm the initial findings from **2024**. The team aims to replicate the extreme pressures found in deep-sea environments within a controlled laboratory setting, enabling a more thorough understanding of the processes occurring in these isolated oceanic depths. (Source: Nature)



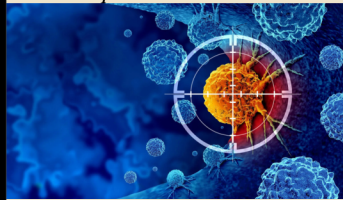
To avoid accusations of AI cheating, college students are turning to AI

The rise of generative AI on U.S. campuses has triggered an "arms race" between students and faculty. As professors turn to AI detectors to catch potential cheaters, many students—including those who haven't cheated—are being falsely flagged due to the software's unreliability. This is particularly common among non-native English speakers. In response, students are increasingly using "humanizer" tools. These services, ranging from free to \$20/month, rephrase text to bypass AI detection. While some use them to hide actual cheating, others employ them as a defensive measure to prevent false accusations and avoid the legal or academic fallout associated with AI suspicion. (Source: NBC News)



Scientists turn tumor immune cells into cancer killers

Researchers at KAIST have developed a groundbreaking therapy that focuses on activating immune cells known as macrophages within tumors to enhance the fight against cancer. This pioneering research, led by Professor Ji-Ho Park, represents a significant advancement in cancer treatment. The team discovered that by administering this innovative therapy directly into a tumor, macrophages are able to absorb the drug, which subsequently leads to the production of CAR proteins. This crucial transformation turns them into CAR-macrophages, empowering them to efficiently identify and eradicate cancer cells. Consequently, these modified macrophages become formidable agents in the immune system's battle against cancer, offering new hope for more effective treatment options that could revolutionize cancer therapy. (Source: Science Daily)



Discovery Alert: An Ice-Cold Earth?

A candidate exoplanet, HD 137010 b, has been identified as potentially resembling Earth, although it may have a significant distinction: it could be colder than the eternally frozen Mars. Scientists are diligently analyzing data collected by NASA's Kepler Space Telescope, which was retired in 2018, and are continually uncovering intriguing findings. A recent study has indicated the presence of a possible rocky planet slightly larger than Earth, orbiting a Sun-like star approximately 146 light-years away. This candidate planet, pending further confirmation, is anticipated to have an orbital period comparable to that of Earth, roughly one year.

HD 137010 b may also lie at the outer edge of its star's "habitable zone," an orbital region where conditions could allow for the presence of liquid water on the planet's surface, assuming it possesses a suitable atmosphere. Planets that orbit stars beyond our solar system are designated as "exoplanets." This particular exoplanet could mark the first instance of an Earth-like body transiting the face of a sufficiently bright and nearby Sun-like star, thereby enabling significant follow-up observations. (Source: NASA)



Wordle for kids



	2		6	4	3	7	8	5
5	6		1				4	2
					7			
6		4			5			
9	3			6		4	5	7
7	5	2			1	8		6
		3		5			7	
		5	2	3	6			4
			7				2	3

Honey Garlic glazed salmon

Welcome to a culinary delight that perfectly balances sweet and savory flavors—our Honey Garlic Glazed Salmon. This dish is a true testament to how simplicity can yield the most exquisite results. With a rich, sticky glaze made from honey and garlic, this salmon is not only quick to prepare but also a showstopper on any dining table. Whether you're impressing guests or treating yourself to a gourmet meal at home, this recipe promises to deliver a burst of flavor in every bite. Dive in and enjoy the unique blend of textures and tastes that make this dish a favorite for all occasions.

- Pat salmon filets dry and season with spices on all sides.
- Heat butter and oil, then add garlic, water, soy sauce, sriracha, honey and lemon juice.
- When hot, add salmon filets (skin side down if your filets have skin), and cook 3 minutes.
- While salmon cooks, use a spoon to baste the filets.
- Broil for 5-6 minutes, until salmon is sticky sweet, slightly charred, and cooked to desired doneness.
- Salmon filets: 4 pieces
- Spices: 2 tablespoons
- Butter: 2 tablespoons
- Oil: 1 tablespoon
- Garlic: 2 cloves, minced
- Water: 1/4 cup
- Soy sauce: 2 tablespoons
- Sriracha: 1 tablespoon
- Honey: 2 tablespoons
- Lemon juice: 1 tablespoon

